

Telehealth Consultation Guidelines

HealthFirst Medical Group — Patient & Clinician Reference

1. Overview

Telehealth services allow patients to consult with licensed healthcare providers remotely via secure video or audio platforms. These guidelines define eligibility, appointment procedures, technical requirements, and limitations applicable to all telehealth encounters at HealthFirst Medical Group.

2. Eligible Conditions for Telehealth

- Minor illnesses: cold, flu, sore throat, urinary tract infections
- Chronic disease management: diabetes, hypertension, asthma follow-ups
- Mental health consultations: anxiety, depression, medication review
- Dermatology: rashes, acne, minor skin conditions (photo-based review)
- Post-operative follow-ups where physical examination is not required
- Prescription renewals for existing, stable medications

3. Conditions Requiring In-Person Visit

- Chest pain, difficulty breathing, or signs of stroke
- Physical injuries requiring imaging or wound care
- New controlled substance prescriptions
- Conditions requiring lab work, blood draws, or diagnostic procedures
- Pediatric sick visits for children under 2 years of age

4. Medication Refill Policy via Telehealth

Medication refill requests may be reviewed during telehealth visits under the following conditions: the medication must already be prescribed and active in the patient's chart; the patient must not have experienced new adverse reactions; and the medication does not fall under Schedule II controlled substances. Refill requests for opioids, benzodiazepines, or stimulants require an in-person evaluation.

5. Technical Requirements

Requirement	Minimum Standard
Device	Smartphone, tablet, or computer with camera
Internet Speed	5 Mbps download / 2 Mbps upload

Browser	Chrome 90+, Firefox 88+, Safari 14+
Platform	HealthFirst SecureVisit Portal (HIPAA-compliant)
Audio	Microphone required; headset recommended

6. Appointment Scheduling

Telehealth appointments can be scheduled through the patient portal at portal.healthfirst.com, by calling 1-800-555-0190, or via the HealthFirst mobile application. Same-day slots are available Monday through Friday from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM and Saturday from 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM. Patients should join the virtual waiting room 5 minutes before their scheduled time.

7. Privacy and HIPAA Compliance

All telehealth sessions are conducted over end-to-end encrypted channels in full compliance with HIPAA regulations. Patients must consent to telehealth services prior to their first virtual visit. Sessions are not recorded without explicit written consent. Patients should conduct visits from a private location to protect their own health information.